

JULIAN LEE-SURSIN

Curriculum Vitae — August 2026

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AREAS OF INTEREST:

Philosophy of Language/Linguistics, Philosophy of Mind/Cognitive Science, Philosophy of Science

APPOINTMENT

Visiting Scholar (*chercheur invité*), JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY, 2025–2026
Department of Comparative Thought and Literature (CTL)
Report available here: julianleesursin.com/Rapport_de_sejour_final.pdf

EDUCATION

ÉCOLE NORMALE SUPÉRIEURE, **MS** in Cognitive Science 2024–present
17/20 GPA (first year)¹

JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY, Visiting Graduate Student (CTL) 2025–2026

SORBONNE UNIVERSITÉ, **MPhil**, 2023–2025
Mention très bien (highest honors)
Spécialité : Philosophie des sciences, de la connaissance et de l'esprit

OBERLIN COLLEGE, **BA**, French and Philosophy, Honors in Philosophy 2020–2023

PAPERS (Drafts available upon request)

IN PROCEEDINGS

1. (forthcoming, 2026) “Panpsychism and the Individuation Problem: Comments on Taofeek”
Southwest Philosophy Review, 42 (2)

IN PREPARATION

- “Subject-Dependence in Science: The Argument from Complementarity” (with Hong Joo Ryoo)
- “A Regress Argument Concerning Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents” (with Hong Joo Ryoo)
- “Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?”
Manuscript, *Winner of the Indiana Philosophical Association 2025 Graduate Paper Prize*
- A paper on mental models and informativeness
- A paper on why-questions
- A paper on composition and metalinguistic negotiation

¹Grades in France are assigned on a scale from 0–20. An average of 10 is passing, 12 awards honors (*mention assez bien*), 14 awards high honors (*mention bien*), and 16 awards highest honors (*mention très bien*).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* = abstract refereed ** = paper refereed † = invited

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| 25. “Is Acquaintance A <i>Sui Generis</i> Epistemic Relation” (**)
Southwest Philosophical Society, El Paso TX | Nov 13-14, 2026 |
| 24. “A Truthmaker Semantics for Constraint-Based Explanation” (**)
Illinois Philosophical Association, Normal, IL | Oct 16-17, 2026 |
| 23. “A Regress Argument Concerning Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents” (*)
(with Hong Joo Ryoo)
SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria | Sep 4, 2026 |
| 22. “Presentism Precludes Explanation” (**)
European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain | Aug 28, 2026 |
| 21. “Curb Your (Brain-Model Alignment) Enthusiasm” (*)
(with Arnold Fleishman)
European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain | Aug 26, 2026 |
| 20. “A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism” (**)
Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Reading, UK | July 10, 2026 |
| 19. “An Explanatory Cognitive Model for Blackwell Informativeness” (*)
International Conference on Model-Based Reasoning, Rome, Italy | June 18, 2026 |
| 18. “Answering Why-Questions” (*)
Swedish Congress of Philosophy, Stockholm, Sweden | June 13, 2026 |
| 17. “On Fashion’s Perceptual Content” (**)
European Society for Aesthetics, Jyväskylä, Finland | June 9, 2026 |
| 16. “Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation?” (*)
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD | Apr 25, 2026 |
| 15. “On Fashion’s Perceptual Meaning” (**)
American Society for Aesthetics, Eastern Division, Philadelphia, PA | Apr 10, 2026 |
| 14. “On Why-Questions” (†)
Semantics Lab, Department of Cognitive Science, JHU, Baltimore, MD | April 9, 2026 |
| 13. “A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism” (**)
UF Graduate Philosophy Conference, Gainesville, FL | April 4, 2026 |
| 12. “Why Presentism Precludes Explanation” (*)
Central APA, Philosophy of Time Society, Chicago, IL | Feb 18, 2026 |
| 11. “How Causation Explains: A Semantic Inquiry” (*)
Eastern APA, Society for Philosophy of Causation, Baltimore, MD | Jan 7, 2026 |
| 10. “Fashion and the Jacksonian Mode: Intentionality Beyond Language” (**)
Symposium, Institut Français de la Mode, Paris, France | Nov 20, 2025 |
| 9. “Semantics for Explanation” (**)
Illinois Philosophical Association, Charleston, IL | Nov 8, 2025 |

8. “Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation” (†) Nov 3, 2025
Talk for philosophy majors and faculty, Oberlin College, Oberlin, OH
7. “Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?” (**) Nov 1, 2025
Indiana Philosophical Association, Bloomington, IN
6. “Semantics for Explanation” (**) Oct 24, 2025
University of Toronto Grad Conference, Toronto, Canada
5. “Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?” (*) Oct 16, 2025
CREPH: Mind Conference, Liège, Belgium
4. “Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation?” (*) Oct 9, 2025
International Ontology Congress, Basque Country
3. “The Special Questions Dispute” (**) Sep 5, 2025
SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria
2. “The Special Questions Dispute” (**) July 13, 2025
Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Glasgow, Scotland
1. “Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation” (†) May 9, 2025
Salvador Mascarenhas Lab Meeting, Institut Jean Nicod, Paris, France

COMMENTS (†)

- Jon Joey Telebrico: “Epistemic Debt and Responsibility” Apr 25, 2026
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD
- Adekunle Taofeek: “The Individuation Problem for Plant Souls in Panpsychist Ontology” Nov 22, 2025
Southwest Philosophical Society, Savannah, GA
- Patrick Skeels: “There can be no Dispute” Nov 8, 2025
Illinois Philosophical Association, Charleston, IL

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS (Selected)

9. **Research Fellowship**, Johns Hopkins University (\$12,000) 2025–2026
Fellowship stipend to conduct research as a Visiting Scholar
8. **Tuition Subsidy**, Johns Hopkins University (\$66,670) 2025–2026
Full subsidy to take any course(s) as a visiting graduate student
7. **Honorarium**, Institut Français de la Mode (€1,600) Nov 2025
Award for presentation at the Fashion and Language Symposium
6. **Graduate Paper Prize** (\$100) Oct 2025
Best paper presented by graduate student at the Indiana Philosophical Association
5. **Bursary**, CREPH ARC research project: MIND (€500) Aug 2025
Funding for presentation at the University of Liège
4. **Travel Grant**, Sorbonne Philosophy Department (€500) May 2025
Funding for 2025 Joint Session presentation in Glasgow
3. **Paul W. Wurzbürger Prize in French** (\$1,000) May 2023
Concours de la Maison Française de Cleveland, affiliated with the Alliance Française

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| 2. Prix Lahaurine-Johnston (\$1,000) | May 2022 |
| Annual prize for investment in Oberlin's Maison Française | |
| 1. John F. Oberlin Merit Scholarship (\$30,000 total) | 2020–2023 |
| Merit scholarship, renewed for all three years I was at Oberlin | |

TEACHING

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| OBERLIN COLLEGE | 2021–2023 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Sole Grader and Tutor, Deductive Logic • Tutor: Philosophy, French, Math, CS, Latin, Econ • Sole Resident Assistant, Maison Française (2022–2023) • TA (weekly session as sole instructor), Intermediate French (Spring 2021) | |
| US MILITARY / ROCHESTER INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY | Summer 2021 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Sole instructor: Robotics, CS, and Biochem courses for the Army Educational Outreach Program | |

EMPIRICAL RESEARCH

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| MICHIGAN STATE UNIVERSITY, Arnosti Lab | Summer 2019 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Investigated modified retinoblastoma (Rbf) gene in <i>Drosophila</i> using dCas9 chimeras | |
| FLORIDA STATE UNIVERSITY, Arbeitman Lab | Summer 2018 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Tasked with CRISPR & U6-gRNA cloning, <i>Drosophila</i> cortex dissection, and gel electrophoresis | |
| NATIONAL HIGH MAGNETIC FIELD LABORATORY, Condensed Matter Lab
(under the supervision of Johan van Tol) | 2015–2017 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Designed a millimeter wave resonator. When measuring polymers (e.g., polystyrene), intensity increased by a factor of 8, pulselengths decreased by a factor of 3-4 (compared to measurements without the resonator). • Built miniature solar-powered vehicle using CAD and soldering | |

SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

Member: American Philosophical Association (Eastern), American Society for Aesthetics, Aristotelian Society, European Society for Aesthetics, European Society for Analytic Philosophy, Philosophy of Time Society, Society for Philosophy of Causation, Southwestern Philosophical Society

Board Member: Youth Advisory Board, National High Magnetic Field Laboratory (2021–2023)

Editor: *The Synapse: Intercollegiate science magazine* (2021–2022)

VARIA

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| Fashion: I performed in Paris Fashion Week (<i>Duranimal</i>) and the Saut Hermès Dinner | Mar 2025 |
| Music: I've studied voice (bass), including at Oberlin and at the Peabody. Notable concerts: | |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Verdi's <i>Macbeth</i> with Plácido Domingo (Salle Gaveau) • Rossini's <i>Le Comte Ory</i> (Théâtre des Champs-Élysées) | <div>Apr 2025</div> <div>Nov 2024</div> |

- Bastille Day Parade (ft. the Olympic torch) July 2024
- Royal Philharmonic Orchestra, dir. Joe Hisaishi (La Défense Arena) Apr 2024
- Mozart's Mass in C minor at Les Invalides Dec 2023

GRADUATE COURSEWORK

- **École Normale Supérieure**²
 - Cognitive Models and Artificial Intelligence (Fall 2026, Heike Stein)
 - Evolutionary Foundations of Social and Cultural Behaviors (Fall 2026, Nicolas Baumard & Jean-Baptiste André)
 - Neurons, Networks, and Behavior (Fall 2026, Karim Benchenane)
 - Perception, Memory, and Core Knowledge (Fall 2026, Claudia Lunghi, Pascal Mamassian & Marine Lunven)
 - Semantics (Spring 2025, Salvador Mascarenhas)
 - Language (Fall 2024, Salvador Mascarenhas)
 - Representational Foundations of Mind (Fall 2024, Denis Buehler)
- **Johns Hopkins University**³
 - Advanced Topics in Philosophy of Mind and Cognitive Science (Spring 2026, EJ Green/Mason Westfall)
 - Puzzles about Belief (Fall 2025, Jeremy Goodman)
 - Truth-makers and Mental Models (Fall 2025, Justin Bledin)
- **Sorbonne Université**⁴
 - Philosophy of Techniques and Technology (Spring 2025, Anouk Barberousse)
 - Philosophy of Mathematics (Spring 2025, Olivier Rey)
 - Philosophy of Science in English IV (Spring 2025, Cécilia Bognon-Küss)
 - Metaphysics of Science (Fall 2024, Max Kistler)
 - Philosophy of Economics (Fall 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
 - Philosophy of Science in English III (Fall 2024, Anouk Barberousse)
 - Epistemology and Metaphysics (Spring 2024, Jean-Baptiste Rauzy)
 - Philosophy of Mind/Cognitive Science (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
 - The Implicit (Élise Marrou)
 - Advanced Logic (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
 - Philosophy of Science in English II (Spring 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
 - Authenticity (Existentialism) (Spring 2024, Claude Romano)
 - Scientific Reasoning (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
 - Philosophy of Biology (Fall 2023, Cédric Paternotte)
 - Philosophy of Physics (Fall 2023, Vincent Ardourel)
 - Intro to Logic (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
 - Philosophy of Science in English I (Fall 2023, Rayan Geha)
 - Husserlian Phenomenology (Fall 2023, Dominique Pradelle)

REFERENCES

Available upon request

²Listed ENS courses were taught in English.

³Courses taken as a visiting student at JHU are audited.

⁴Courses at Sorbonne Université were taught in French (titles translated by me), except 'Philosophy of Science in English' I-IV.